FUNCTIONAL BLUEPRINT #03

Delivery, Resource & Capacity Management

Prescriptive outcomes powered by dedicated Databricks pods in 12-week quarterly execution blocks.

SECTION 01 Commercial Model

Prescriptive Outcomes Powered by Governed Pod Capacity

Midmarket clients buy defined, bounded cloud data milestones. Internal delivery operates on dedicated, autonomous sprint pods—eliminating hourly timesheet friction while protecting delivery margins.

HOURLY T&M

The Efficiency Penalty

Hourly Billing (T&M)

Billing hours penalizes speed; using automated code or templates destroys billable revenue.

- **Adversarial Margins:**
  Automated pipelines and reusable IP finish projects faster, which directly reduces billable revenue in hourly contracts.
- **Commodity Friction:**
  Client procurement reduces senior engineers to interchangeable rate cards, inviting constant pressure from offshore vendors.
- **Administrative Overhead:**
  Constant disputes over 15-minute timecard increments and individual consultant productivity rather than outcome velocity.

UNHEDGED FIXED PRICE

The Delivery Trap

Unhedged Fixed Price

Open-ended scope and client credential/environment delays are absorbed 100% by firm payroll.

- **Client Dependency Stalls:**
  Slow client IAM approvals, schema changes, or missing test environments halt sprint DoD sign-offs and lock up invoice releases.
- **Firm Absorbs 100% Downside:**
  Client organizational friction and external stalls are absorbed entirely by consulting payroll with no billing relief.
- **Scope Creep Escalation:**
  Subjective interpretations of "Done" cause friction at milestone boundaries and compress project margins.

C5.0 GOVERNED PODS

The Sweet Spot

Prescriptive Outcomes & Governed Pods

Prescriptive deliverables defined as an agreed **Target Milestone Backlog** estimated in velocity points and executed across fixed-capacity 2-week sprints—not an unhedged fixed-price warranty. Sprint capacity is reserved; client owns backlog priority, while Pod Leader owns technical quality gates.

- **Pre-Paid Sprint Reservation:**
  Sprints are invoiced and collected prior to Day 1 of each 2-week cycle, securing zero DSO and predictable cash flow.
- **Dedicated Sprint Capacity:**
  Client owns product backlog priorities; our Pod Leaders own architecture reviews, automated PR gating, and delivery velocity.
- **12-Week Quarterly Blocks:**
  6-sprint minimum commitments eliminate project bench churn and give midmarket clients budgetable OpEx line items.

Sprint Backlog Rollover Protocol

Capacity Rule

Collapse

Sprints operate on fixed capacity reservations. Backlog tickets are story-pointed and prioritized by business value. If an engineering task is uncompleted at Day 10 due to underlying schema complexity, it automatically rolls into the top of the next sprint's backlog prioritization under client product ownership. Sprint capacity burn continues predictably without contractual disputes or unbilled overtime.

💡 **Delivery Mandate & Mobilization Runway** `Commercial Rule` Collapse

Clients purchase structured, milestone-driven outcomes delivered through reserved pod capacity. Internal operations govern delivery by committed vs. uncommitted sprint blocks across a 6-week rolling horizon. All client SOW contracts incorporate a mandatory **3-to-4 week mobilization runway** post-deposit before Sprint 1 Day 1, establishing controlled start dates, squad alignment, and platform scaffolding.

SECTION 02 Squad Topologies (Whole Headcount)

Standardized Core (3-FTE) & Scale (5-FTE) Delivery Squads

Eliminating internal fractional roles. All pod engineers are 100% dedicated to a single client backlog, with leadership overlay spans calibrated for maximum utilization.

MIDMARKET WORKHORSE

$66,500 / Sprint ($133,000 / mo)

Core Pod (3.0 Dedicated FTEs)

Target Profile: Midmarket lakehouse migrations, dbt transformation modeling, Databricks SQL reporting.

100% DEDICATED SQUAD ROSTER

Lead Data Engineer (Pod Leader) Client Tech Leader — 1.0 FTE

Client technical point-of-contact, architecture alignment, PR sign-off.

Senior Data Engineer Pipelines & Compute — 1.0 FTE

Ingestion pipelines, Lakeflow Connect, Delta Lake, Spark compute.

Analytics Engineer Semantic & dbt — 1.0 FTE

dbt models, semantic layer definitions, Databricks SQL dashboards.

🛠️ SPRINT 0 PLATFORM FOUNDATION — 1–2 Wk Scaffolding

For custom or greenfield cloud environments lacking starter DABs, a 1-to-2 week **Sprint 0** is executed by the Principal Architect and Pod Leader to provision Unity Catalog metastore bindings, storage credentials, Private Link networking, and tailored DAB scaffolds. Full Core Pod mobilizes on Sprint 1 with zero infrastructure friction.

SHARED LEADERSHIP OVERLAY (4:1 SPAN — 70/20/10 MODEL) — 70% Delivery Load

Principal Architect 0.20 FTE

Scoping, high-risk design, DoD gates (4 pods = 80% span; 70% delivery).

Delivery Manager 0.20 FTE

Sprint cadence, velocity, schedules (4 pods = 80% span; 70% delivery).

70/20/10 Model: Senior leaders operate under 70% delivery governance, 20% technical presales, and 10% IP lab—freeing pod engineers to remain 100% committed to sprint backlog execution.

SPRINT RATE & BASE MARGIN

Direct Cost: ~$28,013 / sprint • **Base Margin: 57.9%**

$399,000

12-Wk Block (6 Sprints)

ENTERPRISE VELOCITY ENGINE

$105,000 / Sprint ($210,000 / mo)

Scale Pod (5.0 Dedicated FTEs)

Target Profile: High-throughput streaming, complex legacy warehouse replatforming, enterprise Unity Catalog governance.

100% DEDICATED SQUAD ROSTER

Lead Data Engineer (Pod Leader) Client Tech Leader
System architecture, high-risk components, client executive alignment.
1.0 FTE

Senior Data Engineers (2 FTEs) Streaming & Lakehouse
Streaming CDC, lakehouse storage layers, liquid clustering, Spark optimization.
2.0 FTE

Analytics Engineer Testing & Semantic
Enterprise data testing, dimensional modeling, semantic metrics.
1.0 FTE

DataOps & Platform Engineer IaC, DABs & FinOps
Databricks Asset Bundles (DABs), Terraform IaC, FinOps DBU tracking.
1.0 FTE

SHARED LEADERSHIP OVERLAY (3:1 SPAN — 70/20/10 MODEL) 70% Delivery Load

Principal Architect 0.25 FTE
Enterprise architecture, Lakehouse security, DoD gates (70% delivery).

Delivery Manager 0.33 FTE
Sprint throughput, risk escalation, account governance (70% delivery).

Enterprise Span: 1 leadership pair oversees up to 3 Scale Pods under the 70/20/10 model, delivering enterprise velocity while pod engineers remain 100% dedicated.

SPRINT RATE & BASE MARGIN

Direct Cost: ~$45,153 / sprint • **Base Margin: 57.0%**

$630,000
12-Wk Block (6 Sprints)

SECTION 03 Scale Architecture (20–60 FTEs)

Scaling via Autonomous 3-to-4 Pod Delivery Clusters

Phase 1 reaches maximum operational efficiency at 4 Core Pods (14 people total) under a single cluster leadership pair. Phase 2 begins when Pod 5 launches (~20+ headcount), triggering Cluster 2 and formally

funding the dedicated Central Resource Operations Leader. Delivery capacity scales horizontally up to 60 FTEs without bureaucratic overhead.

SCALING PILLAR 01

Cluster Topologies

Modular Delivery Clusters & Leadership Swarming

Delivery clusters function as modular capacity envelopes governing 12 to 15 delivery engineers. Pods remain standardized, while cluster leadership flexes across three supported topologies:

1. Core Midmarket Cluster (14 People Total) — 80% Active Load

4 Core Pods (12 Engineers) governed by 1 Principal Architect + 1 Delivery Manager operating at an optimal 80% active oversight load (4 × 0.20 FTE).

2. Scale Enterprise Cluster (17 People Total) — 75%–100% Load

3 Scale Pods (15 Engineers) governed by 1 Principal Architect (75% load) + 1 Delivery Manager (100% load) for high-throughput streaming and complex governance.

3. Composite Hybrid Cluster (13–16 People Total) — 65%–75% Load

Mixed client portfolios (e.g., 2 Midmarket Core Pods + 1 Enterprise Scale Pod = 11 delivery engineers). Maintains leadership utilization between 65% and 75% without reorganizing squads or hiring extra overhead.

⚡ Cluster Leadership Swarming & Dedicated Squad Isolation:

- **Dedicated Squad Isolation:** Delivery squads remain 100% dedicated to their client backlog and never cross account boundaries, strictly preserving client data isolation and NDAs.
- **Stop-the-Clock Protocol:** If a client encounters IAM or environment stalls, the pod pivots to secondary backlog items or internal Brickbuilder IP (billing continues uninterrupted).
- **Leadership Shock Absorber:** The cluster leadership pair shifts excess oversight hours to swarm sister pods, accelerating complex code reviews, DAB promotions, and production deployment gates.

⏱ Staggered Pod Intake Rule

≥ 1 Sprint Separation

Within any delivery cluster, new pod kickoffs must be staggered by a minimum of **one 2-week sprint cycle**. A single Principal Architect cannot onboard more than one new client pod concurrently—preventing front-loaded intake spikes (40%–60% Arch load) from creating architectural governance or PR review bottlenecks.

SCALING PILLAR 02 Centralized Practice Operations

Central Resource Operations Hub

Separating individual project delivery management from practice-wide capacity planning, competency-based staffing, and forward pipeline matching:

Dedicated Role Funded at Pod 5 (~20+ Headcount)

Phase 2 Trigger

Launching Pod 5 forms Cluster 2 and activates the dedicated **Resource Operations Leader** ($185k loaded). This role manages practice-wide scheduling, stack-skill inventory matching, and rolling 6-week forward capacity booking.

Tiered Pipeline Reservation Protocol

STAGE 1 **70%+ Win Probability (Provisional Demand Profiling):** Triggers stack competency tagging (Databricks, dbt, Spark, Unity Catalog) and tentative scheduling in the resource planning tool. *Zero payroll commitments made.*

STAGE 2 **Contract Execution (Hard Capacity Booking):** Dedicated squad locking occurs exclusively upon SOW execution and verified collection of the **initial 2-sprint capacity reservation deposit**.

Controlled Kickoffs & 3–4 Wk Mobilization Runway

Paced Onboarding

Kickoff dates are locked into a forward-looking capacity calendar. The standard **3-to-4 week mobilization runway** post-deposit gives recruitment and resource management a predictable window to assemble the squad, provision cloud sandboxes, and complete Sprint 0 platform tasks without burning unassigned bench payroll.

Competency-Based Matching Over Interchangeable Heads

Staffing allocations match verified cloud competency tags, Databricks certifications, Liquid Clustering experience, and dbt modeling skills rather than treating consultants as fungible headcount.

SECTION 04 Interactive Planning Widget

Practice Capacity, Margin & IP Leverage Simulator

Model team scale, cluster leadership loading, and see how reusable Brickbuilder IP expands practice gross margins in real time.

SQUAD ARCHITECTURE TIER: Core (3 FTE) vs Scale (5 FTE)

Core Pods (3 FTEs) | Scale Pods (5 FTEs)

IP ACCELERATOR MULTIPLIER: Baseline (0% IP)

Baseline (Zero IP) | IP-Accelerated (C50)

Active Concurrent Client Pods:
Simulate practice scale, cluster leadership loads, and financial performance

SELECTED: 3 Active Pods

1 Pod (Phase 1 Start) **4 Pods (Core Cluster Optimum)** 6 Pods (Phase 2 Mid) 10 Pods (Enterprise Scale)

TOTAL PRACTICE HEADCOUNT

11 People

9 Engineers + 2 Leaders

PRINCIPAL ARCHITECT LOAD

60% Load

1 Principal Architect

Scoping, high-risk review & DoD gates

DELIVERY MANAGER LOAD

60% Load

1 Delivery Manager

Sprint velocity, risk & account cadence

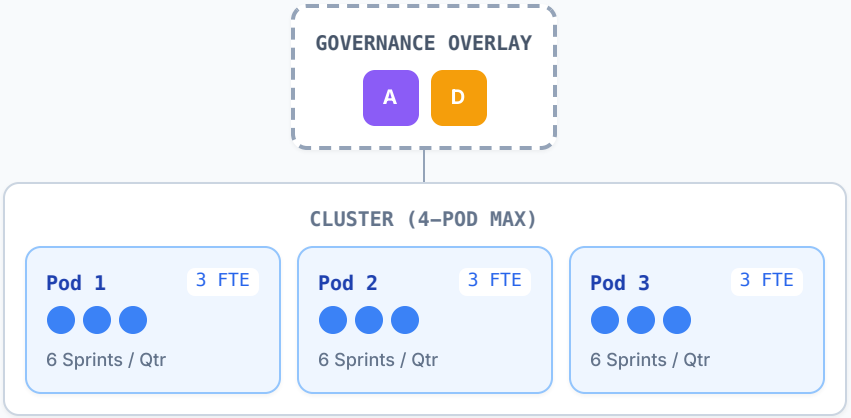
QUARTERLY POD VELOCITY

18 Sprint Units

6 Sprints / Qtr / Pod

Live Team Structure Core pod = 3 dedicated engineers. Clusters group up to 4 pods under 1 leadership pair (80% load).

Quarterly Output: **18 Sprint Units**



Dedicated Engineer · Principal Architect · Delivery Manager · Resource Operations Leader

Practice Revenue & Margin at This Scale

Revenue = pods × sprint fee × 24 sprints. Cost = squad direct cost (adjusted by IP efficiency if active) + whole-person cluster leaders.

ANNUAL REVENUE

$4,788,000

$1,197,000 / quarter

DIRECT DELIVERY COST

$2,141,500

Squads $1,830,000 + cluster leaders $311,500

GROSS PROFIT

$2,646,500

Revenue less direct delivery cost

PRACTICE GROSS MARGIN

55.3%

Meets 55% Target

Pod-level margin (direct labor + 70% delivery governance) is 57.9%. 20% leadership presales allocated to OpEx (Sales & Marketing).

⚠ **Bootstrap Phase Margin Caveat (<3 Pods)** Scale Advisory Collapse

At 1 to 2 pods, carrying whole-person senior leaders ($260k Principal Architect + $185k Delivery Manager) creates temporary leadership under-utilization, bringing practice gross margin below the 55% target. This planned capital investment is mitigated by maintaining an active sales pipeline backlog that drives pod expansion toward full cluster capacity. 20% of senior leadership cost is accounted for under Sales & Marketing (OpEx).

⚡ **Operating at 3 Concurrent Pods**

Cluster architecture groups pods under dedicated leadership pairs. Headcount scales smoothly up to 60 FTEs with peak governance leverage maintained via staggered pod onboarding cadences across the cluster.

SECTION 05 Autonomous Operations & Tooling

The AI-Driven Operating Harness: Scaling Delivery Without Bureaucracy

Augmenting shared leadership spans, automating project mobilization, and preserving persistent client memory across scaling pods.

Why the Agentic Operating Harness Exists

Under our **70/20/10 model**, 1 Principal Architect and 1 Delivery Manager govern 3 to 4 pods concurrently (a 3:1 or 4:1 span). The Agentic Harness automates the 15–20 hours/week of administrative tax (status tracking, ticket grooming, and routine PR audits), freeing leaders to focus strictly on high-risk architecture, client health, and technical presales.

LEAN GOVERNANCE MULTIPLIER

15–20 Hrs / Leader / Wk Saved

COMPONENT 01 Shared Leadership Augmentation

Agentic Project Management Harness

Sustains 3:1 to 4:1 Cluster Spans

Two specialized autonomous agents absorb daily administrative overhead across pod environments, drafting actions and surfacing blockers so shared leadership can inspect high-leverage exceptions rather than drowning in routine telemetry.



Delivery Operations Agent

Supporting Delivery Manager

Maintains operational cadence across 3–4 pods simultaneously, converting async discussions into actionable governance artifacts:

- **Async Standup Synthesis:** Summarizes pod Slack threads & commits, filtering noise and auto-flagging blockers.
- **Predictive Velocity Rollover:** Evaluates ticket burndown at Day 7, forecasting rollover risks before sprint end.
- **Stop-the-Clock Triggers:** Auto-drafts contractual pause notices when client IAM/environment stalls exceed 24 hours.

Technical Governance Agent

Supporting Principal Architect

Enforces architectural conformance and FinOps guardrails, auditing code and compute before human architect review:

- **DoD Pre-Validation Gate:** Runs automated checks against Gates 01–03, catching missing tests or schema issues.
- **FinOps DBU Auditing:** Queries Databricks system tables every 6 hours for expensive queries and idle cluster hours.
- **ADR Generation:** Synthesizes architectural trade-offs from PR comments and Slack discussions into draft ADRs.

COMPONENT 02 Sales-to-Delivery Handoff

Intelligent Project Bootstrapping & Mobilization

3–4 Week Mobilization Runway

An automated mobilization engine executing during the mandatory post-deposit runway, translating commercial contracts into operational code and pre-provisioned environments so pods achieve full velocity on Day 1 of Sprint 1.

MOBILIZATION RUNWAY COUNTDOWN (POST-DEPOSIT CLEARANCE)

Standard 3–4 Week Window

T-21 Days Step 1

Inception Dossier

Deposit cleared; commercial contract auto-converted to operational mandate.

T-18 Days Step 2

Prerequisites Portal

Client receives tracked onboarding checklist (VPC, IAM, Unity Catalog).

T-14 Days Step 3

Code Scaffolding

Brickbuilder templates cloned; DABs and CI/CD pipelines parameterized.

T-7 Days Step 4

Sprint 0 Validation

Architect verifies cloud metastore connectivity & acceptance criteria.

Sprint 1 Day 1 ✓ GO

Full Pod Velocity

Squad executes locked user stories; zero provisioning downtime.

Project Inception Dossier

Ingests sales transcripts & SOWs into a 1-page operational mandate with stakeholders & compliance rules.

Prerequisites Engine

Deploys an interactive client portal tracking IAM, VPC peering, and schemas with automated reminders.

Automated Scaffolding

Clones Brickbuilder starter repos; parameterizes Terraform and DABs with dev/stage/prod CI/CD.

Ready-State Backlog

Pre-populates story-pointed tickets aligned to Bronze/Silver/Gold layers ready for Sprint 1 Day 1 execution.

COMPONENT 03 Central Operating Nucleus

The Context Hub: Central Nervous System of Agentic Delivery

Immutable Client Memory Graph

CONTINUOUS ENGAGEMENT DIGITAL TWIN

70/20/10 Coordination Multiplier

The Context Hub: Central Nervous System of Agentic Delivery

AI-driven delivery cannot scale using disconnected tools. The Context Hub maintains an immutable, continuously updated digital twin of each client engagement across time, multiple projects, and scaled pods. It combines episodic communication memory with semantic technical truth, ensuring all 6 delivery agents act with shared, long-term intelligence.

⚡ **70/20/10 Span Protection:** Eliminates the administrative overhead of cross-pod coordination, allowing Principal Architects and Delivery Managers to maintain their 3:1 or 4:1 pod governance span without burnout.

Zero Tribal Knowledge Loss

RADIAL SYSTEM TOPOLOGY

Hub & Spoke: Central Memory Graph Orchestrating 6 Satellite Engines

Bidirectional Telemetry

Shared Context Hydration

SATELLITE 06 • TOP LEFT

Tooling Integration & Orchestration Bus

Slack/Teams conversational interface, event-bus webhooks, and enterprise RBAC/data isolation inside tenant cloud boundaries.

Slack • Webhooks • RBAC

⇅ Stream Sync

SATELLITE 01 • TOP CENTER

Delivery Operations Agent

Asynchronous standup synthesis, blocker triage, ticket velocity trajectory, and automated Stop-the-Clock pause drafting.

Supports Delivery Manager

⇅ Stream Sync

SATELLITE 02 • TOP RIGHT

Technical Governance Agent

Automated Definition of Done Gates 01–03, FinOps DBU consumption tracking, and automated ADR synthesis from code reviews.

Supports Principal Architect

⇅ Stream Sync

CENTRAL NUCLEUS

CONTEXT HUB (Client Memory Graph)

Persistent bidirectional semantic memory store synchronizing interactions, code state, architecture decisions, and client organizational tendency in real time.

- Episodic Event Stream
- Technical Truth
- Organizational Dynamic
- Longitudinal History

SATELLITE 05 • BOTTOM LEFT

Multi-Pod Scale & Expansion

Instant squad context hydration in < 48 hours for Pods 2–N, technical debt indexing, and commercial expansion opportunity signaling.

Rapid Hydration • Debt Index

⇅ Stream Sync

SATELLITE 04 • BOTTOM CENTER

Client Environment Readiness

Client credential/networking checklist, automated readiness scoring, and Sprint 0 Databricks Asset Bundles (DABs) infrastructure validation.

IAM • VPC • Sprint 0 Gates

⇅ Stream Sync

SATELLITE 03 • BOTTOM RIGHT

Sales-to-Delivery Scaffolding

Project Inception Dossier generation, CRM call transcript parsing, SOW requirement scoping, and Sprint 1 Day 1 ready-state backlog.

CRM • SOW Dossier • Backlog

⇅ Stream Sync

PERSISTENT MEMORY ARCHITECTURE

The Four Core Memory Pillars: How the Context Hub Retains Operational Truth

4-Tier Data Matrix

PILLAR 01 — Interactions

Episodic Interaction Stream

Continuous chronological logging of Slack/Teams threads, sprint ceremonies, standup updates, and blocker tickets.

OPERATIONAL VALUE:

Eradicates daily status meetings; captures implicit blockers and client approval timestamps.

- Zero Status Meeting Drag

PILLAR 02 — System Truth

Semantic Technical Truth

Deep indexing of Databricks Asset Bundles (DABs), Unity Catalog lineage, dbt models, Git commits, and FinOps system tables.

OPERATIONAL VALUE:

Gives agents verified technical ground truth to validate Definition of Done gates and flag schema drift.

- Verified Ground Truth

PILLAR 03 — Dynamics

Organizational Dynamic

Records client governance hierarchies, review turnaround times, infosec nuances, and internal approval patterns.

OPERATIONAL VALUE:

Shields pods from organizational landmines; anticipates review bottlenecks before they impact delivery.

- Predictive Review Routing

PILLAR 04 — History

Longitudinal History

Retains cross-project knowledge, unfulfilled backlog items, architectural debt registers, and historical velocity across quarters.

OPERATIONAL VALUE:

Enables Pods 2–N to onboard in 48 hours without tribal knowledge transfer; equips sales with expansion data.

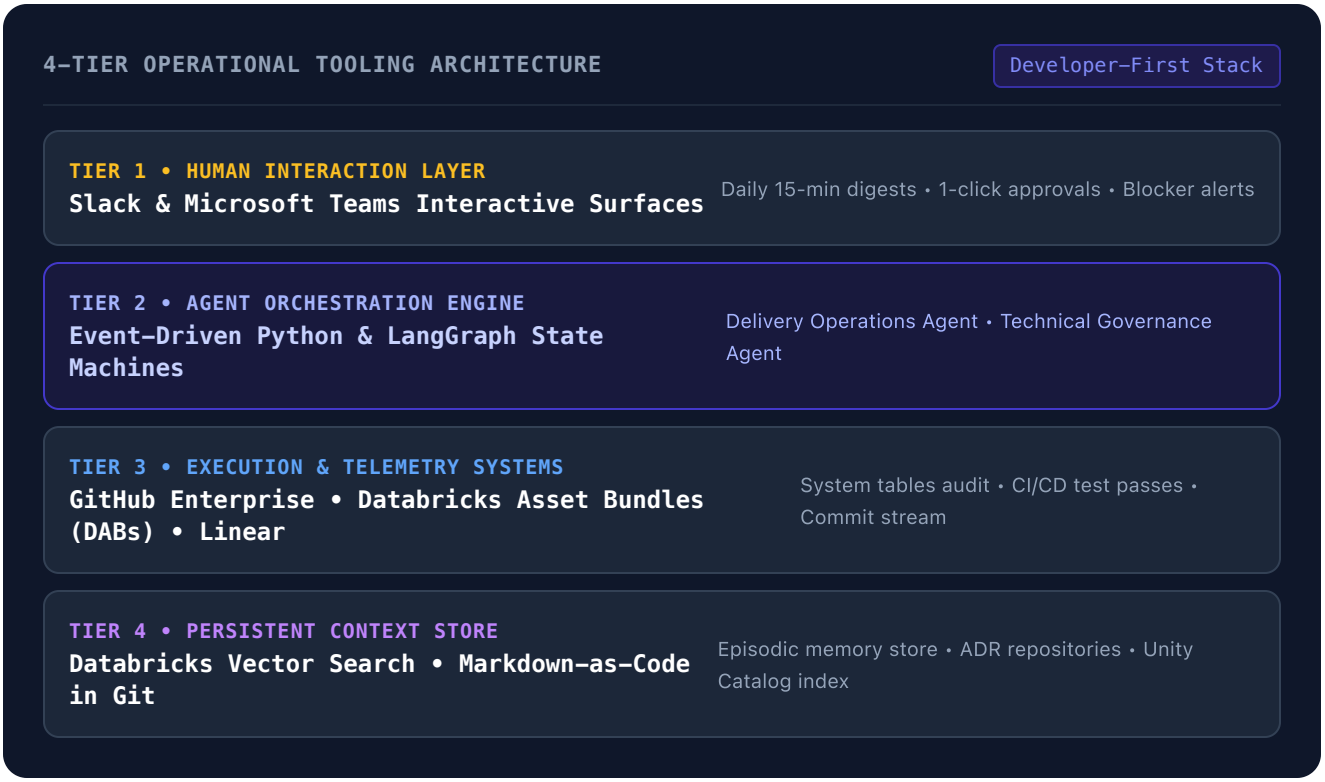
- 48-Hour Squad Hydration

COMPONENT 04 System Architecture

Pragmatic Tooling Integration Architecture

Zero Dashboard Fatigue

A unified 4-tier operational stack built directly upon existing developer interfaces (Git, Slack, Databricks), keeping overhead near zero and eliminating portal sprawl.



COMPONENT 05 Scaling Roadmap

Phased Adoption Roadmap (Crawling to Running)

Aligned to Headcount Milestones

A deliberate 3-stage deployment path tying automation sophistication directly to pod volume and organizational maturity, preventing premature over-engineering before delivery practices stabilize.

PHASE 1A — Pods 1–2 (3–10 FTEs)

Foundation & Standard Templates

Standardize Brickbuilder repos, parameterized DABs skeletons, Git-grounded ADRs, and manual checklist onboarding.

Milestone: Zero Boilerplate Drift

PHASE 1B — Pods 3–4 (11–17 FTEs)

Agentic Assistant Layer

Deploy Technical Governance Agent for automated DoD gating; launch Slack async standup digest agent for delivery managers.

Milestone: 15–20 Hrs/Wk Reclaimed

PHASE 2 — Pod 5+ (20–60 FTEs)

Full Harness & Context Graph

Integrate Central Resource Operations Hub with Client Knowledge Graph; automated Stop-the-Clock contracts & instant multi-pod workspace provisioning.

Milestone: Horizontal 60-FTE Scale

Agent Governance & Human-in-the-Loop Oversight Protocol

GOVERNANCE RULE Collapse

All autonomous agents operate strictly under a **Human-in-the-Loop (HITL)** mandate. Agents draft, monitor, summarize, and flag—they never execute unreviewed production code changes, never merge release candidate branches without human Pod Leader sign-off, and never trigger external commercial notices without Delivery Manager authorization. All training data and contextual embeddings remain strictly isolated inside tenant cloud boundaries, adhering to zero data retention and strict enterprise NDA boundaries.

Strict Human Authorization • Zero Data Leaks Across Accounts

SECTION 06 Work Distribution

The 70/20/10 Leadership Capacity Engine

Balancing active delivery oversight, technical presales growth, and reusable Brickbuilder asset creation across senior practice leadership. Pod engineers remain 100% committed to sprint backlog execution.

🎯 **Dedicated Squad Focus & Leadership 70/20/10 Mandate** Capacity Rule Collapse

Core Pod Delivery Engineers: 100% dedicated to client sprint backlog execution (80 hours per 2-week cycle). Zero fractional splits, zero presales distraction, and zero administrative overhead.

Leadership Overlay Resources (Principal Architects & Delivery Managers): Governed by the **70/20/10 capacity model** (70% billable delivery oversight, 20% technical presales & co-selling, 10% Brickbuilder IP lab).

CORE & SCALE POD ENGINEERS 100% Dedicated

100% Client Backlog Execution (80h / 2-Wk Cycle)

Pod Leaders, Senior DEs, and Analytics Engineers work exclusively on client user stories, transformation pipelines, and semantic models. Completely shielded from non-pod meetings, presales scoping, or firm administrative tasks.

LEADERSHIP OVERLAY (ARCH + DM) 70/20/10 Model

70% Delivery (56h) | 20% Presales (16h) | 10% (8h)

Principal Architects and Delivery Managers divide capacity across active delivery governance (56h), technical presales & partner co-selling (16h), and Brickbuilder IP lab (8h).

70%

56 Hours / Cycle

Active Delivery Oversight

Cross-pod architectural design, high-risk code reviews, DoD release gates, delivery manager sprint cadence, and delivering paid 2-week architectural assessment audits. Direct delivery burden modeled in COGS.

20%

16 Hours / Cycle

Technical Presales & Channel Growth

Statement of Work (SOW) scoping, story point estimation, Databricks co-sell partner meetings, PAM alignment, and prospective client technical discovery. Accounted for under Sales & Marketing (OpEx).

10%

8 Hours / Cycle

Practice Lab & Brickbuilder IP

Harvesting generic Databricks Asset Bundles (DABs), dbt semantic models, and automated Terraform lakehouse templates to maintain official Brickbuilder partner accreditation and accelerate client onboarding.

SECTION 07 DoD Gates & IP Asset Factory

Automated DoD Release Gates & The Reusable IP Engine

Ensuring code quality via automated gates while systematically converting project learnings into reusable practice assets.

GATE 01 Day 1

Sprint Intake & Asset Bundles

Backlog locked, Databricks Asset Bundles (DABs) provisioned or completed Sprint 0 platform foundation verified, acceptance criteria locked, and sprint capacity confirmed reserved.

Billing Pre-Paid 100% Cash Secured

GATE 02 Days 4–8

Automated Pipeline QA

100% pass on dbt tests, automated schema assertions, and mandatory peer PR approvals by the Pod Leader.

Automated Testing Zero Regression

GATE 03 — Day 9

FinOps & DBU Consumption Audit

System tables query check verifying query cost, cluster auto-termination limits, and Unity Catalog lineage tagging.

Cost Governance — DBU Optimized

GATE 04 (TIER 1) — Day 10 (Bi-Weekly)

Bi-Weekly Staging Acceptance & Code Freeze

Governs sprint completion: Pod Leader and Delivery Manager verify all committed stories pass automated QA and dbt tests in client staging. Code merges to release candidate branch, unlocking client review without triggering commercial warranty mid-project.

Staging Accepted — RC Code Freeze

TIER 2 QUALITY GATE — Week 12 / Sprint 6 Milestone

Quarterly Production Promotion & Warranty Gate

At the conclusion of the 12-week capacity block (Sprint 6), the Delivery Manager and Client Executive Sponsor execute the formal Production Sign-Off. Production branch is deployed, handoff documentation is delivered, and the contractual **30-day warranty period commences**.

Production Sign-Off

30-Day Contractual Warranty

🔄 Sprint Backlog Rollover Protocol

Sprints operate on fixed capacity reservations. Backlog tickets are story-pointed and prioritized by business value. If an engineering task is uncompleted at Day 10 due to underlying schema complexity, it does not trigger a contract dispute or unpaid overtime. Unfinished tickets automatically roll into the top of the next sprint's backlog prioritization under client product ownership. Sprint capacity burn continues predictably.

Predictable Capacity Burn

🚀 The IP Compounding Loop & Margin Expansion

Every 10% IP Lab allocation feeds the Brickbuilder Asset Factory. Reusable assets reduce new client onboarding and pipeline construction by **35%–40%**. Because sprint fees are fixed based on outcome delivery, efficiency gains translate directly into expanded gross margins (**55% baseline → 68%+ realized**).

55% → 68%+ Margin Expansion

Client Dependency Stop-the-Clock Protocol

If a client encounters internal access delays, cloud credential roadblocks, or missing data schemas, the pod immediately pivots to secondary backlog items or internal Brickbuilder IP sprints. **Sprint capacity billing continues without interruption.** The firm never absorbs client organizational friction on its payroll.

`Zero Payroll Absorption`